

NairaPlate plan: cash paid out of the drawer

Status: plan for approval. Nothing is built or changed yet. **Date:** 3 October 2026 **Why:** expected cash in a drawer only counts money coming in. When a cashier hands drawer cash to someone for a market run, gas or a supplier, the shift shows a shortage and raises an alert, even though the cashier did nothing wrong. This plan makes cash going out a recorded, reversible, audited entry, in the same style as the other ledgers.

1. Your decisions (3 October 2026) and how this plan applies them

Decision	How it is applied
Cashiers record routine cash-outs up to an owner-set limit; above it the owner approves or an Owner logs it	Section 3 and 4
Purchases and supplier settlements reduce expected cash only if "Paid from drawer" is ticked	Section 5
Catering deposits carry a payment method in the same step	Section 6
Offline resilience gets its own scoping document	Separate PDF

2. What changes in the sum

Today: **expected cash = float + cash sales (net of part refunds) + cash catering payments + cash debt payments.**

After this step: **expected cash = float + cash sales + cash catering payments (now including deposits that carry a cash method) + cash debt payments – cash paid out.**

"Cash paid out" is the total of payout entries on that shift, minus any that an owner reversed. The sum stays in the one place it lives today (`src/lib/cash-drawer.ts`), and a closed shift keeps the breakdown it was worked out from, with a new line "Paid out". Closed shifts from before this step are not restated.

3. The payout entry (database)

A new append-only table, `cash_drawer_payouts` , belongs to one shift. Nobody signed in can write, edit or delete it directly. Only database functions write to it.

Entry kind	Meaning	Counts in expected cash?
payout	Cash left the drawer and is approved	Yes (minus)
request	A cashier asked for a payout above the limit	No, until approved
approval	The owner approved a request: this is a payout row tied to the request	Yes (minus)
decline	The owner declined a request	No

Entry kind	Meaning	Counts in expected cash?
reversal	The owner cancelled a payout (reason of 5+ characters). Carries a minus amount	Cancels the payout

Each entry stores: amount, category, a note (5+ characters), who, when, and the link to what it cancels or approves. A request is never changed. It is settled by a new row that points at it, and the database allows only one settling row per request.

Categories: market run, gas or fuel, transport, supplier settlement, other (the note must say what for). Payouts created from a purchase or supplier payment carry that link instead (Section 5).

Rules the database enforces: - A payout can only attach to the single open shift. No open shift means "Open a shift first". - Amount above zero. Note of 5+ characters. Reversal needs a reason of 5+ characters, owner only, once per payout. - A shift **cannot be closed while a request is waiting**. The owner approves or declines it first. This applies to every close, including an owner closing a shift someone left open, so the numbers always agree. - Cashier: may record a payout directly while the running total of payouts they recorded on this shift stays within the limit. The first one that would pass it becomes a **request** instead. (Using the shift's running total stops a cashier getting round the limit by splitting one big payout into several small ones.) - Owner and Supa Admin: any amount, directly, and may approve, decline and reverse. - Cook, purchaser and visitors: cannot record a free-standing payout. - Each business's limit is stored in a small settings table that only a database function can change (owner only, audited). Default ₦10,000.

Audit lines (new): cash payout recorded, requested, approved, declined, reversed, and "payout limit changed".

4. The screens

Cash drawer, open shift - A new section "Cash taken out" with a button **Take cash out**: amount, category, note. - A cashier above the limit sees the button change to **Ask the owner**. The request raises an alert for the owner. - The shift's payouts are listed with who, what and why. Owners see **Reverse** on each. - Owners see **Waiting for approval** with **Approve** and **Decline**. - If a request is waiting, **Close shift** is disabled with the reason.

Closed shifts show "Paid out" in the breakdown.

Owner only: Payout limit. A small field on the Cash drawer page to set the limit.

5. Purchases and supplier payments: "Paid from drawer"

- The Purchases screen and the supplier payment screen each get a checkbox, **Paid from the cash drawer**. It is shown when the payment is cash. It is off by default.
- When ticked, the purchase or payment and its payout entry are saved **together or not at all**. If no shift is open, the screen says so and nothing is saved.
- Purchasers and owners may do this at any amount. The purchase itself is the evidence, so no approval step.
- **Reversing the purchase or payment automatically reverses its payout**, with the same reason, in the same step. A purchase that was not paid from the drawer is not touched.
- These two actions use new database functions that call the existing ones (`log_purchase` , `record_supplier_payment`) and add the payout. The released functions are not edited.

6. Catering deposits get a payment method

- A deposit taken when the order is created is saved with a method (cash or transfer). The new order form asks for it whenever a deposit is entered.
- A cash deposit is counted in expected cash from then on. Reversals carry the same method, so they net out.
- The two existing deposits have no method and stay uncounted, as today.
- The old order function (without the method) is removed only after the new screen is live, so a deposit can never be saved without a method again.

7. Order of work, in the same pattern as earlier steps

Part	What	When it runs
A	New table, functions, shift-close guard, settings, catering function with method, deposit rule. Old screens keep working.	Before the screens are released
Code	Cash drawer, Purchases, supplier payment and catering screens; expected-cash calculation and the server close route; tests	One release
B	Remove the old catering function (no method)	After the screens are live

Each part comes with a check query and a rollback. The rollback refuses to run once real payout entries exist.

8. How it will be tested

1. **Local database copy:** each role (cashier under and over the limit, owner, purchaser, cook, visitor, another business), the running-total rule, request, approve, decline, reverse, the close guard, the purchase and supplier links in both directions, the catering method rule, repeat runs and the rollback.
2. **Unit tests** for the expected-cash sum with payouts, requests, reversals and catering deposits.
3. **A live rehearsal** that undoes itself, added to the existing one.
4. **Screens:** a new section in the UAT scripts, step by step, for the payout, the approval and the checkboxes.

9. What this does not do

- It does not stop a cashier taking cash and recording nothing. The count at close will still show that as a shortage, which is correct.
- It does not check the payout against cash in the drawer. A payout bigger than the expected cash makes expected cash negative and the owner sees that.
- Old closed shifts are not restated.

10. Questions I need answered before building

1. **Purchaser free-standing payouts.** I have allowed purchasers to take drawer cash out only through the "Paid from drawer" boxes. Do you also want a purchaser to be able to record a free-standing payout, for example a market run with no purchase attached?

2. **The limit.** Per shift running total (my recommendation, it blocks splitting) or per single payout?
3. **The default.** ₦10,000 until the owner changes it. Right?
4. **Categories.** Market run, gas or fuel, transport, supplier settlement, other. Anything to add or remove?
5. **Waiting requests and closing.** I have made a waiting request block every close until the owner decides. Are you happy with that?